



the more we realise that we know very little! So, AI is a boon for us in that sense.

Time to move to AGI

Artificial general intelligence (AGI) aims to mimic human intelligence, enabling it to make decisions autonomously, just like a human being. But when AGI starts replacing humans, what will we all do?

Do we really need to do something? How about basking in the Sun on a beach or besides a swimming pool, with a drink of our choice in our hands? But where will the money for the drink come from? Yes, that needs to be worked out!

Oh, how about making AI work and earn for us?

AGI is the next big thing! Many companies the world over are working on it, but mainly in the USA at present. It is likely to take at least two to three years to emerge, or possibly longer. So far, it is a hypothetical kind of intelligence where a machine learns and starts 'thinking' and working like a human being.

OpenAI, of which Elon Musk was a part earlier, is a pioneer in this field. Elon Musk and Sam Altman established OpenAI in December 2015 in San Francisco. At present, Sam Altman is heading it. Its stated goal is to ensure AGI benefits all of humanity. They have to their credit the GPT series, including GPT-4 and GPT-4.5.

Google/Alphabet is working on DeepMind AGI model with neuroscience-inspired architectures and scalable learning. Their projects include AlphaGo, AlphaZero, AlphaFold, and the AGI-capable model Gemini.

xAI, founded by Elon Musk in March 2023, has as its mission to "Understand the true nature of the universe." It has Grok chatbot as its initial project with the long-term focus on AGI.

Meta (Facebook), led by Mark Zuckerberg as CEO, aims to build an 'open-source AGI.' Their AI projects include LLaMA models, multi-modal AI, and AI assistants.

Microsoft, in partnership with OpenAI, is focusing on

the integration of AGI into their products like Windows, Office, and GitHub CoPilot. They are working on AI scaling, safety, and infrastructure.

Besides such companies from the USA, Mistral AI from France is working on open-weight LLMs (large language models), possibly aiming toward AGI. In China, Huawei, Baidu, Tencent, and Alibaba are also doing some AGI research. There are also several academic institutions, such as Stanford AI Lab, UC Berkeley, MIT CSAIL, Oxford, and Cambridge, conducting foundational research on AGI and AI alignment. Of course, IBM Research is also active in this field.

In India, the emerging players working on AGI-related research include IIT Madras, IISc Bangalore, and some other IITs in Delhi, Mumbai, Kanpur, and Hyderabad. In the private sector, TCS and Infosys are laying the groundwork for infrastructure and models that may enable broader AGI research.

Some startups in India also claim to be working on strong AI or AGI-like systems. Noteworthy among these are Sarvam AI, backed by OpenAI's ex-researchers, Krutrim by Ola founder Bhavish Aggarwal, and VigyanLabs, which is exploring some AGI-enabling tools.

The harsh truth is that India is not yet at the forefront of AGI research, although the Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) has launched programmes like the 'National AI Portal' and the 'IndiaAI Mission' to help scale AI research and innovation. DRDO (Defence R&D Organisation) and ISRO (Indian Space Research Organisation) are acting on their own plans for AGI-related initiatives.

Moving on to ASI

Although we are still working on artificial general intelligence, there is